

Chronic Illness & Adherence Support

Learner guide | SWP-017 | School of Medical & Health Social Work

This guide supports a three-part learning sequence for Chronic Illness & Adherence Support. By the end of the course, you should be able to support people living with chronic conditions to overcome practical and psychosocial barriers to care.

Practice notice: Apply the law, organisational policy, supervision requirements, and approved referral pathways that govern your setting. This material supports learning and does not replace urgent safeguarding, clinical, or legal procedures.

Learning objectives

- Support people living with chronic conditions to overcome practical and psychosocial barriers to care.
- Apply the key ideas from Living with chronic illness.
- Apply the key ideas from Understanding adherence barriers.
- Apply the key ideas from Collaborative support plan.

Course structure

Module	Focus	Suggested study time
1. Living with chronic illness	illness burden, stigma, social determinants, self-management, and strengths	10 to 15 minutes
2. Understanding adherence barriers	beliefs, cost, access, literacy, side effects, mental health, and family factors	10 to 15 minutes
3. Collaborative support plan	goal setting, education, reminders, referrals, monitoring, and advocacy	10 to 15 minutes

Module 1 Living with chronic illness

This module focuses on illness burden, stigma, social determinants, self-management, and strengths. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Illness burden
- Stigma
- Social determinants
- Self-management
- Strengths

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of living with chronic illness in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of illness burden, stigma, social determinants, self-management, and strengths. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through living with chronic illness safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 2 Understanding adherence barriers

This module focuses on beliefs, cost, access, literacy, side effects, mental health, and family factors. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Beliefs
- Cost
- Access
- Literacy
- Side effects
- Mental health
- Family factors

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of understanding adherence barriers in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of beliefs, cost, access, literacy, side effects, mental health, and family factors. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through understanding adherence barriers safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 3 Collaborative support plan

This module focuses on goal setting, education, reminders, referrals, monitoring, and advocacy. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Goal setting
- Education
- Reminders
- Referrals
- Monitoring
- Advocacy

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of collaborative support plan in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of goal setting, education, reminders, referrals, monitoring, and advocacy. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through collaborative support plan safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Course activity

Use the accompanying worksheet to apply the course sequence to a short case. Your completed activity should show what you noticed, the action you would take within your role, and what you would escalate or verify locally.

Assessment preparation

- Review the distinction between: barriers.
- Review the distinction between: collaborative goals.
- Review the distinction between: adherence supports.

References and local adaptation

- SWEEP Academy Course Content Outlines, production blueprint for this course.
- The current legislation, professional standards, safeguarding procedures, and referral directories for the delivery jurisdiction.
- The learner's employer or placement policy, supervision arrangements, and documentation standards.